

Kamal Joshi

Senior / Staff Backend & Platform Engineer | Go | AWS | Kubernetes | Distributed Systems | API Infrastructure | Security

Austin, TX | Open to remote-friendly and hybrid roles | Open to relocation for the right opportunity
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior software engineer and technical leader with 18+ years of experience building highly available distributed systems, backend platforms, API gateways, cloud-native services, security products, and enterprise integration systems. Proven track record of end-to-end production ownership — from architecture and API design through incident leadership and systemic reliability improvements. Over the last two years I have gotten genuinely effective at directing AI tools (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Codex) to produce safe, testable, readable code across the full SDLC while owning the design, quality bar, and business outcome. Known for anticipating future needs, earning management trust as a dependable technical anchor, and designing services that prove their value across multiple product cycles.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Backend/platform engineering:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, gRPC-Web, JSON/HTTP APIs, webhooks, microservices, event-driven systems, SQL
- **Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, AWS Secrets Manager, Terraform modules, Terraform pipelines, multi-account infrastructure, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD
- **Security/product domains:** Kong API Gateway, authorization services, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, third-party integrations, threat analytics, secure coding
- **Engineering leadership:** technical design, production ownership, incident recovery, customer escalations, cross-team collaboration, mentoring and coaching early-in-career engineers, pragmatic architecture
- **Platform operations:** multi-region readiness, DLQ recovery, sovereign/GovCloud environments, observability, deployment validation, rate-limit governance
- **Full-stack collaboration:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Angular, API-driven UI workflows
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex across implementation, IaC, testing, debugging, code review, and design exploration; working familiarity with agentic tool patterns (LLM + memory + tool use)

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Owned backend/platform systems including **API Gateway**, **Authorization Service**, and Third-Party Integrations Service, spanning design, implementation, production support, and cross-team coordination.
- Architected real-time **webhook delivery** and **enterprise integrations** for Cisco Secure Access, enabling customer-facing alert/security-event delivery with Chrome Enterprise Browser, Microsoft Intune, and Jamf Pro.
- **Diagnosed and fixed a Jamf / Intune integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation**, helping restore confidence in the product experience and **contributing to the customer's purchase decision**.
- Prevented security-event message loss during a production webhook incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and redriving messages successfully within **5-10 minutes**.
- Drove integrations-svc production readiness across new **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged changes across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, service config, and audit logging, while also validating HA behavior across at least two regions.

- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure in the token flow by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key authentication and APIGW rate-limit behavior, unblocking the customer with a targeted mitigation and driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Drove cross-service design for customer-selected **Splunk** and **CloudEvents** webhook formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications services.
- Led design and delivery of push security events capability using the open **CloudEvents** standard, delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers — a long-awaited product feature enabling real-time security event delivery to customer systems.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Advanced Cisco Secure Access / APIX platform capabilities across API gateway, authorization, integrations, and event-delivery domains.
- Grew into production ownership for backend platform services, helping teams reason through API access, customer integrations, operational readiness, and cross-service dependencies.
- Partnered across product, engineering, and operations teams to turn ambiguous platform problems into implementation plans, rollout paths, and production support decisions.
- Applied Go, AWS, Terraform, event-driven patterns, and API gateway concepts to evolve security-platform services and supporting infrastructure.
- Built auth-tools, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services to simplify OAuth/policy enforcement integration.
- Integrated AI tooling (Claude Code, Copilot, Codex) into daily engineering workflow across the full SDLC — from design exploration and code generation to IaC authoring, test generation, debugging, and code review; pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco initiatives.
- Served as the primary technical point of contact for cross-timezone coordination and engineering decisions, acting as a dependable anchor for management during coverage gaps.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design feedback, and hands-on guidance, helping grow the team's Go and platform engineering capabilities.
- Initiated “Tip Talk Tue,” a recurring team knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and security practices.
- Led ISMAP security certification for the APIX platform, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements and meeting all deadlines.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs for a cloud-native data ingestion platform during the 2020-2021 transition from Java/Spring systems toward Go-based platform services.
- Built API-driven authentication and authorization flows using OIDC, OAuth 2.0, and gRPC-Web interactions.
- Contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs and gRPC APIs from SQL schemas, improving API consistency and reducing repetitive implementation work.
- Designed and implemented a type-assisted search feature for an Active Threat Analytics dashboard, helping security analysts write threat-hunting queries faster and with less friction.
- Developed Spring Boot / Java REST APIs and Angular-based applications for threat awareness and security analytics products, including customer internet-resource registration and authorization workflows.
- Optimized query performance for large IP address ranges and contributed architectural improvements for caching, load balancing, push notifications, and clustered deployments.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding practices, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, internal tools, workflow applications, and integration features across financial services, enterprise content systems, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector domains.
- Turned ambiguous requirements into working product features through rapid prototyping, stakeholder feedback, and cross-team collaboration.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, automation, testing, and maintainable engineering practices before moving into cloud-native security platform work.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University